

Narrative Pitch

This game is a roguelike dungeon crawler focused on a time-loop paradox. The player is at once the past, present, and future versions of the same character.

At the start of each run, an unseen pursuer begins to follow the player a few rooms behind. This pursuer is not an enemy to defeat but a constant source of pressure. If it catches the player, the run ends. Rather than encouraging exploration at any pace, the game makes players constantly weigh speed against risk, reward, and morality.

As the player moves through the dungeon, they collect limited resources that can be used in two ways:

- Invest in personal upgrades to become stronger.
- Spend resources to slow, weaken, or delay the pursuer.

Every resource spent on one goal comes at the expense of the other, forcing challenging trade-offs throughout the run.

The player may face these choices alongside moral dilemmas that have immediate gameplay consequences. They may stop to save an injured survivor, sacrificing valuable time and resources, or leave them behind to gain an advantage. They might drain a sacred source of power to strengthen themselves, knowing it will harm others, or preserve it and face a tougher journey.

None of these choices are clearly right or wrong, they are compromises made under pressure. These decisions go beyond affecting the player's current run / resources. They shape the personality, values, and reasoning of the player's future self.

This influence shows directly in gameplay. The future self does not replicate the player's exact actions, instead, it adopts the player's decision making philosophy. If the player consistently makes utilitarian choices (sacrificing others or exploiting the environment whenever it provides an advantage) the future self will do the same. Sacred power sources may already be drained when the player arrives. Survivors who could have offered aid may already be dead or abandoned. Shortcuts created through destructive choices may already exist because the future self took them first.

On the other hand, a player who often chooses restraint leaves behind a different world. Resources remain intact, survivors may still be alive to provide help, and parts of the dungeon suffer less from exploitation.

In this way, the player's moral philosophy shapes not just who their future self becomes but also the state of the world they inherit.

Throughout the game, the player believes the unseen pursuer is a mysterious enemy. At the same time, they are heading toward a powerful figure deeper within the dungeon whom they believe must be stopped.

In the final room, the truth comes to light.

The final boss is the player's future self. However, they are not waiting for a final confrontation, they are running away from the player, just as the player has been fleeing from the unseen pursuer (the player's past self).

Every version of the player is trapped in the same cycle:

- Chasing the person they believe has gone too far.
- Running from the version of themselves trying to stop them.
- Eventually becoming the very person they once feared.

The tragedy is that everyone believes they are the hero.

Each version has already seen the destruction caused by their future self and thinks stopping them is the only way to prevent even greater harm. Yet every decision they make in pursuit of that goal slowly turns them into the very person they are chasing.

The future self is not evil, nor is the past self. They simply reached the same conclusions under the same impossible conditions.

By the end of the run, the player realizes they have not been escaping the cycle, they have been creating it. Every compromise they justified became a lesson passed forward and back. Every convenient choice became another reason for their future self to make the same decision, leaving its consequences behind for the next version to inherit.

Central Theme

The cycle is not maintained by evil but by justification.

The game examines how ordinary people become capable of causing harm not because they are inherently cruel but because they repeatedly justify tough decisions in pursuit of what they believe is a necessary goal. Under constant pressure, every version of the player thinks they are making the right choices to prevent a greater disaster. Each one convinces themselves that the ends justify the means.

The player's choices do not just determine how they survive; they shape the kind of person they become and the world they leave behind.

Every compromise teaches the future self what is acceptable, and those choices reshape the world the next version will inherit.

The time loop serves as a metaphor for this process while the game poses one question:

- If every compromise can be justified, how do you recognize the moment you've become the person you set out to stop?

In the end, you are not just fighting your future self, you are inheriting the consequences of the person you are becoming, absolving yourself with the belief that the next compromise will be the last one.